Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

June 2010 Volume 53, Number 6 Sunnyvale, California Editor Phyllis Fowler

June Monthly Meeting because of electricity problem at Park building is at 7:00 pm in the Lakewood School Multi-Purpose Room

Dumpster Day is July 17th!

President's Column *-Fred Fowler*

June LVNA Meeting: An Encore for PG&E

Greeting neighbors. The lights are still out at Lakewood Park, but we've decided to have our monthly meeting anyway! For this month, we're moving the meeting to the **Lakewood School Multi-Purpose Room**. It will happen at the same time (7:00pm) and the same day (the 2nd Wednesday). It will just be in a different location!

We're relocating this time because we want to be certain we will have electricity! We need to make sure, since our guest for the meeting will be **Denise Alexander,** Customer Outreach Supervisor from the **Pacific Gas and Electric Company**. Denise made a presentation to us about **PG&E's SmartMeter** program back In April. Unfortunately, she and the rest of us literally got caught in the dark that night. The power to the entire park was out due to a major cable malfunction. She and her assistant did the best they could and they provided a great deal of useful information. Still, the people attending the meeting wanted more and it was decided to invite Denise back for an encore during out June meeting.

Since April, there have been a number of developments in the *SmartMeter* area. Last month PG&E admitted that there are almost 50,000 *SmartMeters* that have malfunctioned, and the State of California is now mounting an investigation. PG&E is also sponsoring a controversial ballot initiative (Prop. 16) that will help lock in its status as a power providing monopoly, by making it very difficult for municipal governments to establish their own electric utilities.

There is a great deal of "information" floating around, some of which is accurate and some of which is not. Come to the June LVNA meeting on **Wednesday, June 9th at 7:00pm**, and get the viewpoint of PG&E straight from the source! There are important issues at stake here that could greatly affect life in our nice little neighborhood. Come find out about them first-hand!

PS: I'm afraid I will not be able to attend the June 9th meeting myself. I'll be traveling in Asia on business. Our 1st Vice President Joan Simon will be handling the meeting for us. Let's give her our support that night and thank her for stepping up to this challenge. ◆

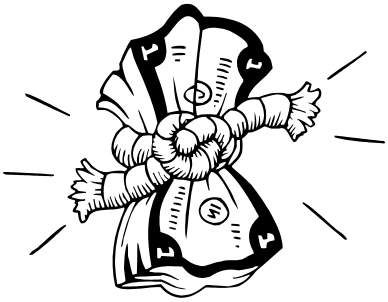
INSIDE THIS

Park Power	2
Budget Cont.	3
Arson	4
Dumpster Day	5
Who To Call	6

City news:

Public Safety Budget Cuts

By Fred Fowler



It is budget time for the City of Sunnyvale, and once again there is not enough money to go around. The bad economy, the stalled downtown project and the general fall in Santa Clara County property values have contributed to another "crisis" where the City Council must make hard choices about spending the monies that they do have. As you know, I have some experience with those situations having served eight years on the City Council myself. The most important thing to remember is that the decisions to be made are *choices*. The Council must use its collective wisdom to *choose* among the many pressing priorities to allocate the available money where it will do the most good for the community.

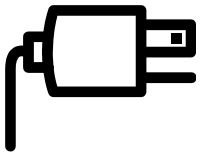
One area I've always felt strongly about is our commitment to maintaining a safe and peaceful community. I think we should not compromise when it comes to law enforcement, fire safety or emergency preparedness. In the past, Sunnyvale was ranked as the 5th safest city in the nation for our size. I think that to be a prosperous and successful community we must first and foremost be a safe community. I would ask the City Council to pay special attention to this area of the budget and make sure funding is adequate, even in hard times such as these.

A few days ago I received an e-mail from Lieutenant Michael Andrade of Sunnyvale DPS. Lieutenant Andrade is the current president of the Sunnyvale Public Safety Officers Association, and he was writing to all of the neighborhood association presidents to let them know about the proposed budget for the Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety. The proposed budget includes some significant cuts. They are so drastic that they make me worry about the consequences of having them come to pass. I hope that the City Council can find a way to avoid these cutbacks, for the sake of the community. ***(Cont. on page 3)***

Back in the 1990s when I first served on the City Council, the Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety had a staff of about 225

 ©2010 Lakewood Village Neighborhood Assoc.

Lakewood Park power update



by Fred Fowler

At the beginning of April the lights went out in Lakewood Park, and things have been dark ever since. Last month I warned the neighborhood about some of the worrisome side-effects of the lack of power, and I said that I would follow up with the City of Sunnyvale to find out what is going on.

A few days ago I received an e-mail from Scott Morton, the Superintendent of Parks for the City of Sunnyvale. Scott is an old friend of the LVNA and of Lakewood Village in general. Two of his initiatives have included the construction of the water based play features in Lakewood park that are so popular in the hot summer months, and also the skate park ramps and jumps that are located in the circular skating "rink" near the Lakewood park building. Scott is as worried and frustrated as we are.

Here is what he says:

"Hello Fred, I'm sure you, along with the rest of the neighborhood, are very aware of the power outage at the park and probably are as frustrated as I am with how long the repair is taking. Although we have been keeping users of the park informed through signage posted at the site as well as direct contact with permitted users, I wanted to send this note to you as the representative of the LVNA. A power cable shorted out between the electrical meter near the tennis courts and the power drop from the PGE line on the other/south side of the park. Originally we thought this was a PGE problem because of the location before the meter, this proved to not be the case as PGE informed us that it was the city's responsibility. Since that time we have been doing everything we can to get our electrical contractor to pull new cables but we are still waiting for ***(Continued next column)***

(Cont.)

PGE to schedule an inspection of the process and hopefully approve the installation, otherwise they will not do the final connection. Each week I am hopeful and then something occurs that delays the completion of the work. I remain hopeful that we can get the work done sooner than later and will continue to strive to do so."

Based on Scott's e-mail, it sounds like all we can do is be patient about the power outage. All we can do is wait, and also pay a little closer attention to what may be going on in the dark out there. Dark places facilitate unsavory activities, and if we notice anything suspicious we should call 911 sooner rather than later. We will need to be a little extra vigilant in order to keep this problem from threatening the peace of our nice little corner of Sunnyvale. Thanks in advance for your help. ◆

◆·◆·◆·◆·◆·◆·◆·◆·◆·◆·◆·◆·◆·◆·◆·◆·◆·◆·◆·

"If you don't know where you are going, you might wind up someplace else. Yogi Berra

INSTYLE BEAUTY
Salon & Barber
1155 Lawrence Expressway • Sunnyvale
Phone: 408-734-2035
NOW OPEN EVERY OTHER SUNDAY –11AM TO 5PM

HOT SUNDAY SUMMER SPECIALS!!!

HAIR CUT.....$3.00 OFF (REG. $13.00 & UP)
ALL CHEMICAL SERVICE:
COLOR, HIGHTLIGHT.....$10.00 OFF REG. PRICE
PERM.....$10.00 OFF REG.PRICE
STRAIGHTENING.....$10.00 OFF REG. PRICE
EYE BROWS WAX.....$ 3.00 OFF(REG. $12.00)
FACIAL.....$ 5.00 OFF(REG. $40.00)
NAIL CARE:
MANICURE.....$ 3.00 OFF(REG 10.00 & UP)
FULL SET OF NAILS.....$ 5.00 OFF REG. PRICE
FREE Consultations on PERMANENT MAKE UP
*****COUPON FOR SUNDAYS ONLY*****
EXPIRES September 19, 2010

RV JONES REALTORS
LINDA GARCIA
BROKER/NOTARY
2235 Grant road~Los Altos
~Neighborhood specialist ~25 years experience~
~Discount commission~Short Sales~Sunnyvale Native~
~Let me answer your Real Estate questions~
408-480-5544
Dre#01826663

DR. FRANCISCO A. MABBAYAD
TASMAN SQUARE DENTAL CARE



ADULTS & CHILDREN
GENERAL & COSMETIC DENTISTRY
CERTIFIED INVISALIGN PROVIDER
IN-OFFICE TEETH WHITENING
ORTHODONTICS (BRACES)
DENTAL IMPLANTS

WEB: www.drmabbayad.com
E- mail: fmabbayad@aol.com

1117 TASMAN DRIVE
SUNNYVALE, CA 94089

Phone: (408) 752-0684

©2010 Lakewood Village Neighborhood Assoc.



Public Safety Budget Continued..

Back in the 1990s when I first served on the City Council, the Sunnyvale department of Public Safety had a staff of about 225 sworn officers. A Sunnyvale sworn officer is a person who has been through both a police academy, a fire academy, and a rigorous screening process. They have the power to make arrests and enforce the laws of our community. They fill many different roles in the areas of police patrol, fire response, crime prevention, traffic enforcement, and emergency preparedness. Since the 1990s the area of emergency medical treatment and response has been added to their duties. The 225 officers in 1997 were very busy, an I would expect them to be even busier if they were all here now.

The recessions of the past decade have had a harsh impact on Sunnyvale DPS staffing. In 2003 I fought hard against an effort to eliminate 15 sworn officer positions within the department. Among other cuts, the City Manager proposed completely eliminating the DPS Narcotics unit. I fought hard and lost back then, and the department went down to 210 sworn officers. As a postscript to that fight, the City Council voted to re-instate the Narcotics unit less than a year later.

As bad as that situation was, the current proposal apparently goes much further. The current idea is to cut *another* 15 officers from the staff. As much of their work as possible would be shifted to civilian staffers within the department. The new total would be only 195 sworn officers. Almost all of them would be spread over the areas of patrol and fire response, leaving virtually none in the Crime Prevention, the Neighborhood Resource Officers, and the Emergency Services programs. Even the Investigations unit would be cut back severely. This is a budget of despair. I fear for the future of the city if this is all we can afford.

The Sunnyvale DPS Chief is a man named Don Johnson. Don is a good man and a smart man, and he is being faced with a very difficult situation. Funds are low and there are many pressing needs within the City of Sunnyvale. Don is reasoning that it is possible for some of the jobs within the department to be done by civilians, and those civilians are less "expensive" to recruit, hire, train, and compensate, than sworn officers. There is a growing national shortage of young people who are both qualified for and interested in a career in public safety. Competition for recruits is always high with other jurisdictions bidding up salary levels in an effort to fill their own sworn officer shortages. The more jobs that can be "civilianized", the more money can be saved, or so the reasoning goes.

The issue I have with that thinking that the most important tasks of the Department of Public Safety *cannot* be done by civilians, and with fewer sworn officers we'll have fewer resources needed to keep us safe.

(Continued next column)

(Cont.)

cannot fight structure fires. Only qualified firefighters can. might be just enough to cope with day-to-day needs, but if something

(408) 733-9218
(408) 398-1328 Cell

TOM WATKINS

TW PAINTING
LIC. NO 562976

BONDED and INSURED
RESIDENTIAL and COMMERCIAL • INTERIOR and EXTERIOR
SATISFACTION GUARANTEED

Bella's Deli
A Family Business
1111 Elko Drive • Sunnyvale
408-744-0485
www/bellasdeli.com
Best Falafel in Town!
BBQ Friday
Sandwiches • Burgers • Mediterranean
Happy Hour 4-7pm
Sports Bar, Pool Table
Hookah
10% Discount with Ad
15% Seniors Discount!
We Deliver • Catering 7 days a week
Open Mon-Fri 7am-10pm • Sat 11am-5pm

(Pubic Safety cont.)

Civilians cannot enforce the law, only sworn officers can. Civilians cannot fight structure fires, only qualified firefighters can. 195 officers might be just enough to cope with day-to-day needs, but if something unusual happens the lack of 15 more could make a (tragic) difference.

Sometimes big events take place that require more than a day-to-day level response. In 2000 there was a riot in downtown Sunnyvale after a "gangsta-rap" promoter passed out hundreds of flyers about an unannounced after-concert party on South Murphy Avenue. In 2003 there was another incident when hundreds of panicky teenagers had to be evacuated from the "Abyss" nightclub after a gang fight broke out near the door. In both instances there was an "all hands on deck" call for all available officers to respond immediately. There have been other less visible instances over the years when similar calls have been made. It makes me very uncomfortable to think the next time something similar occurs there may be 15 fewer fully qualified sworn officers available to answer such an "all hands" call.

There are other aspects of the budget that have me worried. When the 1989 Loma Prieta earthquake struck, the Sunnyvale Office of Emergency Services had a staff of five full time people. The current budget proposal would cut the OES down to just a single civilian employee. That is a situation I'm sure we'll regret the next time a large disaster takes place. I'm crossing my fingers, hoping that the next "big one" doesn't happen soon.

As I said in the beginning of this article, the Sunnyvale City Council has some important choices to make. The choices are not easy (and no one said they would be easy), but they must be made according to what is in the best interests of the community.

I ask the Council to think carefully and choose wisely. Don't compromise our safety in the name of saving money. Balance the books, but make sure we won't regret the consequences of the choices you make. A safe peaceful and prosperous community is the most valuable thing we have. Don't put that in jeopardy because of money. ◆

 ©2010 Lakewood Village Neighborhood Assoc.

Arson on the John Christian Greenbelt

by Fred Fowler

Greetings. I would like to alert all of you to a serous problem for our neighborhood, and ask your help to try to solve it.



About two weeks ago my wife and I were walking our dogs near the Lakewood school when we noticed some thick white smoke coming from a spot on the John Christian Greenbelt just west of Meadowlake Drive. I went to investigate and found that five bushes along the trail had been set on fire. The wind was blowing briskly and was fanning the flames. It wasn't a good situation. I called 911 immediately.

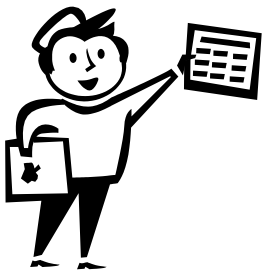
Firefighters from Fire Station #6 responded and were on scene in just a matter of moments. They put out the fire and immediately started sifting through the ashes looking for a cause. I was asked if I had seen anyone nearby or possibly fleeing the scene when I arrived. Unfortunately, I had seen no one.

The firefighters then told me that this was not the first fire they had dealt with on the John Christian Greenbelt. As I walked on towards Hiddenlake drive I noticed what looked like the remnants of at least two other fires in the not-too-distant past. It looks like someone is deliberately burning the brush along the trail. The firefighters have no idea who it may be or why they are doing it.

I would like to ask everyone reading this to keep an eye open for more incidents like this. There are at least 3,500 of us in Lakewood Village, and 3,500 pairs of eyes are hard to hide from. If you notice anything suspicious happening on the John Christian Greenbelt (or in any other part of Lakewood Village), please don't hesitate to call 911. Sunnyvale DPS would rather follow up a tip that turns out to be nothing than to have more incidents like this happen with no clue as to what is behind them.

(continued next column)

WALKERS NEEDED!



We need volunteers to deliver the LVNA Newsletter!

Wendy is looking to fill two routes:

Meadowlake to Lawrence Expressway

Or Hiddenlake and Greenlake

(these can be split into 2 route)

If you are interested please call

Wendy Stanley at (408) 745-1331

(Arson cont.)

Anything you see or hear could be significant. If you notice something that strikes you as odd, please let the authorities know.

Our neighborhood is too nice a place to stand by and let someone try to burn it down. Let's work together to stamp this out. ◆

"To the praise of the glory of His grace . . ."

Providence Bible Church of Sunnyvale
709 Lakewood Drive, Sunnyvale, CA 94089
408-734-2297 **http://www.lvbc-ca.org**

Sunday Services
9:30 a.m. Sunday School for all ages
11:00 a.m. Worship Service

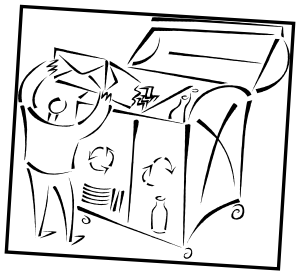
Wednesday
7:00 p.m. Corporate Prayer Meeting

A Better Cheaper TOW
"The Name Says It All"
-Since 1969-
Cell #(408) 509-9299
SBC #(408) 737-9200
AKA - A Friends Tow

Bay Area RoadRunner LLC
Emergency Roadside Service
$10 Discount in Lakewood Village
Lockouts - Jump Starts
Fuel Delivery - Tire Changes
Keep this Coupon in your car
Save $5 anywhere around the Bay
24/365 Dispatch 408-752-0165

 ©2010 Lakewood Village Neighborhood Assoc.

Dumpster Day is Coming!



By Fred Fowler

Hello neighbors. Last month I asked for a *"Tribune of Trash"* or a "*Dumpster Diva*" to head up our annual neighborhood cleanup event. I'm proud to say that a very capable individual has stepped forward! None other than our **2nd Vice President Ralph (Skip) Gottschalk** has signed up to get the event organized and underway. **Let's give Skip a hearty "Thank You!"** and commit to doing our part to make the 2010 Dumpster Day another smashing success.



The date for Dumpster Day has been set for July 17th. That will be just three days after our July general meeting, and we'll use that LVNA meeting to go over the details of the event. Ours is by far the biggest Dumpster Day in the city of Sunnyvale. Other neighborhoods such as the S.N.A.I.L area make do with just six debris boxes, whereas we get twenty regular ones plus a special one just for tires! We need at least 60 volunteers to make it all work. It is a prodigious undertaking, and it takes quite a lot of work to keep all of those ducks in line.

Many thanks and congratulations to Skip for committing to make the entire day work. Many thanks to all of you for doing your part to make this very important neighborhood activity happen once again. I'll see you there.◆

FREEBIES!!!

Coleman 4 person spa

(Motor needs tune-up)

It's taking space in my backyard and is free to whoever picks it up!

Call Phyllis at (408) 747-1454

This area is for advertising free stuff!
If you have stuff you want to give away call Phyllis at (408) 747-1454

HOME MEDICAL SOLUTIONS & SUPPLY



Lift Chairs & Wheel Chairs
Transport Chairs
Walking Aids
No-Rinse Products
Hospital Beds & Tables
Bath Stools & Benches
Bed Wedges, Diapers, Pads
& More!



Sales & Rentals

1260 Persian Dr. Ste A-3
Sunnyvale, CA 94089
(Lawrence Expy & 237)

Bus: (408) 734-2180
(408) 203-5568
M-F 9-6 Sat 10-4

www.hmshomemedicalsolutions.com

Healthy Teeth and Gums for a Lifetime!



LAKEWOOD **DENTAL CARE**

Personalized & Comfortable
Dr. Marilou A. Cuasay
1153 Lawrence Expressway, Sunnyvale, CA 94089
lakewooddentalcare@comcast.net

State-of-the-Art, Lifetime
Dental Excellence in Sunnyvale!

*Professionally trained, caring and Courteous staff
*Help with toothaches and cavities and other dental emergencies
*Lumineers and teeth whitening available
*Convenient 0% payment plans
*Accept all Credit Cards
*Make your dental insurance filing easy

Don't Wait! Stay Healthy! Call today. (408) 541-1900

 ©2010 Lakewood Village Neighborhood Assoc.

Important Phone Numbers

Public Safety - Emergency	**911**
Public Safety - Non-emergency	**730-7100**
Parks and Maintenance	730-7506
Speeding Cars, parking complaints, traffic signal repair, dead animals	Dispatch 730-7180
Complaints about noise or commercial vehicles on residential streets	Desk Officer 730-7110
Complaints about illegal storage, decrepit fences, buildings, weed problems, illegal home businesses or rental housing	Neighborhood Preservation 730-7610
Animal Control	730-7178
City Streets, sidewalks, trees, streetlights,	Public Works 730-7505
Nuisance Vehicle Hotline	730-7706
Drug Hotline	245-3784
Graffiti Hotline	730-7680
Shopping Cart Pickup	725-1010

LVNA Contacts:

President **- Fred Fowler** **(408) 747-1454**
Advertising **- Terry Lin** **(408) 747-1638**
Newsletter Delivery:
Fairwood - Bev Woidyla **(408)736-6225**
Lakewood - Wendy Stanley **(408) 745-1331**

Upcoming Events

Street Sweeping	Your street - move your cars!	7/6 Fairwood 7/13 Lakewood
Household Hazardous Waste Drop-off	near SMaRT Station	6/19 8 am - 1 pm

Termite Police

Office: 408-746-5399
Fax: 408-746-5398
www.TermitePolice.com
Email: termitepolice@yahoo.com

P.O. Box 50550
Palo Alto, CA 94303

Janet Toro's Craft Creations

Specializing in reborn & soft sculptured dolls

Please visit me at:
www.babiesoftherainbow.com
Or at my online shop at:
www.jtoro.etsy.com

jtorocrafts@aol.com
Home: 408-734-0181
Cell: 408-420-1946





Bus: 408-541-1368
Cell: 408-242-6467

Vincent Nguyen
Handyman Specialist

- Install Kitchen Counter Top, Cabinet, Sink
- Bathroom, Shower
- Replace Window, Wood Floor, Pergo or Tiles
- Electrical, Painting, Plumbing, Landscaping
- Fences

Free Estimates
All Work Guaranteed Reasonable Price

PROFESSIONAL PLUMBING
& DRAIN CLEANING

Speedy Rooter

Complete plumbing & remodeling service

FREE ESTIMATE

Justin Cash

Cell: 408.569.9682

HIC Certified
State License #794331
Bonded & Fully Insured

FREE ESTIMATES

- Copper Repipe
- Water Heater
- Garbage Disposal
- Toilet & Faucet
- Water Main
- Sewer Replacement by Trenchless Technology
- Sewer Drain Cleaning
- Clean-out Installation
- Video Camera Inspection
- Pipe Locator
- Bathroom Remodeling
- Tilework
- Gasline

All advertisements in this newsletter are paid ads and support the printing costs. The views, opinions and facts expressed in this newsletter are attributed to the various authors, and do not necessarily reflect the views of the Lakewood village Neighborhood association, its officers or the residents of Lakewood Village.

Editorial Deadline for next month: by June 25th

To contact the editor, Please call Phyllis Fowler at (408)747-1454 or email editor@lvna.net

©2010 Lakewood Village Neighborhood Assoc.